

HMSI SENSITIVE MEDIA INQUIRY POCKET CARD

PROTECT PEOPLE FIRST

QUICK-ACTION OPERATIONAL GUIDE FOR ALL STAFF, WORKERS & VOLUNTEERS

THE CORE PRINCIPLE

"Be helpful without guessing, protect people before reputation, and refer all on-record questions to the designated spokesperson."

Media inquiries are standard accountability, not hostility.

5 UNIVERSAL RULES

- 1. Stop & Identify:** Name & outlet.
- 2. No Guessing:** Never improvise.
- 3. Protect Data:** Zero child disclosure.
- 4. Route Correctly:** One official voice.
- 5. Save Records:** Preserve evidence.

1. THE 5-MINUTE SAFE RESPONSE PROTOCOL

MIN 1: PAUSE & GREET

Stay calm & polite. Do not offer immediate off-the-cuff statements or defensive comments.

MIN 2: CAPTURE FACTS

Note reporter name, outlet, topic, exact questions, format, and publication deadline.

MIN 3: HOLDING LINE

Deliver approved holding script. Provide official email contact@hmsi.org.ng.

MIN 4-5: ROUTE & SAVE

Forward inquiry to Communications Lead. Save message screenshots and timestamps.

EXACT PHONE / VERBAL SCRIPT: *"Thank you for contacting HMSI. I am not authorized to give on-record comments, but I will refer your inquiry to our designated spokesperson for verified information. Please send your deadline and specific questions to contact@hmsi.org.ng."*

2. RAG TRIAGE & ESCALATION THRESHOLDS

Severity Level	Trigger Criteria & Examples	Response Target	Incident Owner
GREEN (Low)	Routine program questions, neutral directory listings, event invitations, public website clarifications.	1–2 business days (Standard response)	Communications Team / Spokesperson
AMBER (Medium)	Disputed metrics/figures, donor/partner concerns, material news criticism, tight deadlines (< 24 hrs).	Triage < 4 hours; Holding line while verifying	Spokesperson & Program Lead
RED (High / Crisis)	Safeguarding / child abuse claims , fraud / fund misuse, data breach, extortion/scam, legal/regulator demand.	Immediate escalation: Zero public debate; Safety/legal priority	Trustees, President & Legal Lead

WHAT NEVER TO DISCLOSE (STRICTLY PROHIBITED)

- No Child Data:** Never disclose minor names, schools, or home locations.
- No Medical / Case Files:** Medical records remain strictly confidential.
- No Personal Accounts:** Never argue or defend HMSI on personal social media.
- No Improvising:** Never guess metrics (e.g. "Food for 30 families is a target").

DATA & ESCALATION CONTACTS

- Official Media Inbox:** contact@hmsi.org.ng
- Safeguarding & Protection:** Mark email subject [SAFEGUARDING]
- Data Privacy Concerns:** Mark email subject [PRIVACY]
- Immediate Physical Danger:** Call local emergency services immediately!